

Study Questions: Action

1. Define **Action** in your own words, specifically as it applies to Middle School.
2. How does the Free Energy Principle constrain our understanding of Action?
3. Contrast the Classical view of Action with the Active Inference view.
4. Explain how every action you take is really an experiment. What prediction are you testing when you raise your hand in class?
5. Why does **uncertainty** make some actions feel scary? Give an example of a high-uncertainty action and a low-uncertainty action from your life.
6. What is a **micro-experiment**? Design one you could try this week to reduce uncertainty about something you have been wondering.
7. A student wants to try out for the school play but is afraid of being rejected. Using the concepts from this module, what advice would you give them?
8. Explain the statement: "There is no such thing as a wasted action." Do you agree or disagree? Use an example to support your answer.
9. Why does your brain make uncertain actions feel uncomfortable on purpose? Was this more useful for ancient humans or modern humans? Explain.
10. Compare taking action to leveling up in a video game. How are small challenges like gaining experience points?
11. Describe the predict-weigh-act-observe cycle using the example of texting someone you do not know very well for the first time.
12. What is the difference between avoiding action because of real danger and avoiding action because of uncertainty? How can you tell which one you are dealing with?
13. Think of a time you took a small action that led to a big positive result. How did that one action update your mental model?

14. If a friend says "I just can't talk to new people," what would you say to help them understand their brain is confusing uncertainty with danger?
15. Why is it better to start with a small experiment (like saying hi) rather than a big action (like asking someone to hang out) when building a new friendship?
16. Your brain predicts you will fail a math test. You study hard and get a B+. Walk through the full cycle: What was the prediction? What was the action? What was the observation? How did your model update?
17. List three actions you have been putting off because of uncertainty. For each one, design the smallest possible version you could try.
18. How does the concept of "actions as experiments" change the way you think about making mistakes?
19. An athlete misses a free throw in a big game. Using active inference language, explain what happened and what their brain learned.
20. Create a "Courage Scale" from 1 to 5 for actions in your life, where 1 is very low uncertainty and 5 is very high uncertainty. Give an example action for each level.